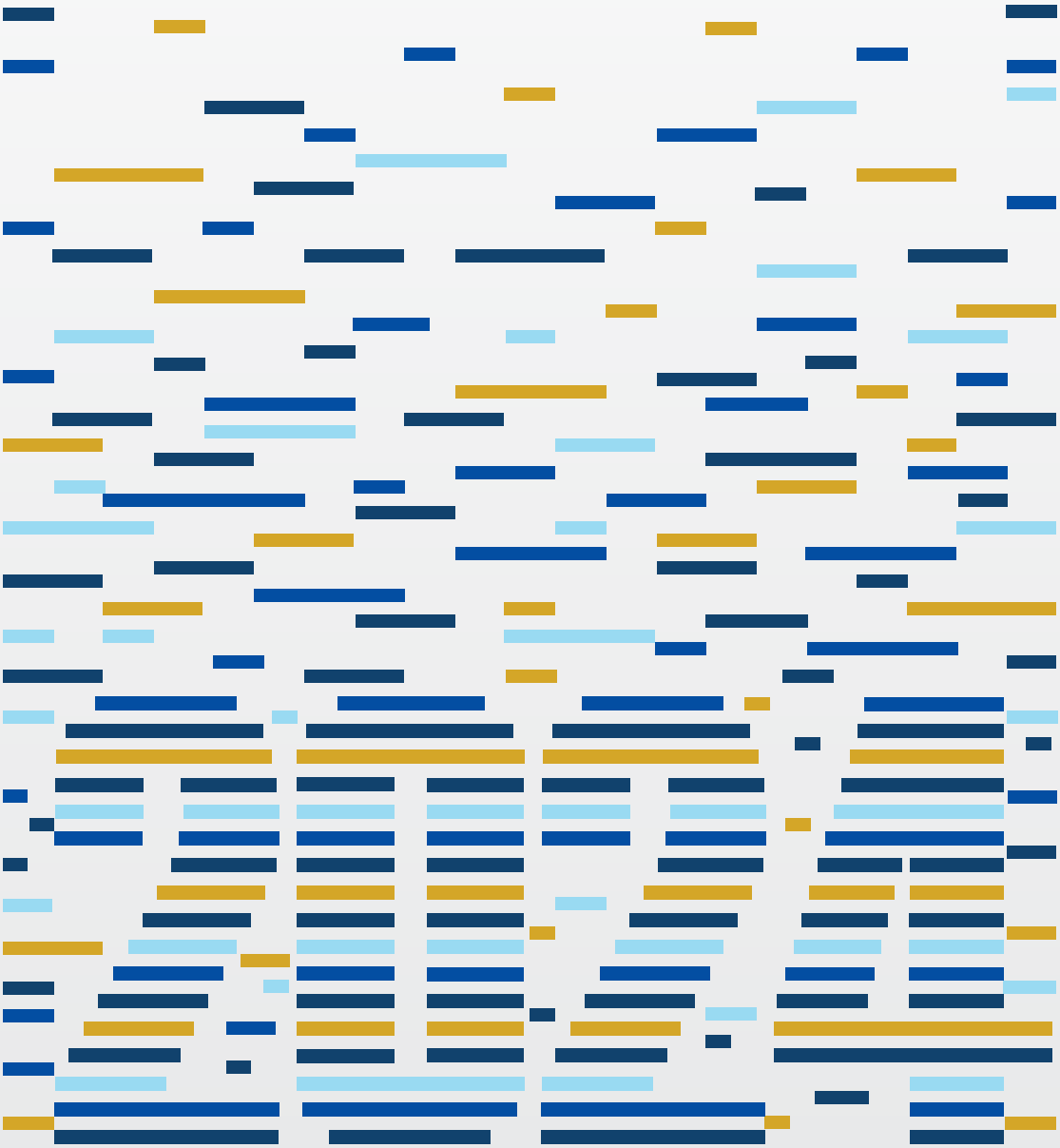
YEAR IN REVIEW



eu-LISA

FOREWORD



2024 was a challenging and remarkable year for eu-LISA, which enabled us to reinforce our resilience and showcase our dedication to a safer and more secure Europe.

In 2024, we ensured the seamless operational management of our existing systems, maintaining their high availability and responsiveness, and thus supporting millions of transactions underpinning operational decisions at the EU borders.
2024 also marked the successful integration of e-CODEX into eu-LISA's systems portfolio, supporting cross-border collaboration between justice practitioners, delivering better services to EU citizens, and accelerating the digitalisation of justice in the EU. Following the adoption of the Pact on Migration and Asylum and the new Eurodac Regulation in June 2024, we immediately started implementing a comprehensive upgrade of the system, with a strong commitment to deliver it fully by June 2026.
In 2024 we also continued to assess the use of new technologies – cloud solutions and artificial intelligence –, focusing on their ability to support evolving EU policies, in line with what regulations allow. eu-LISA remains committed to supporting responsible and ethical innovation, ensuring transparency and accountability, prioritising data protection and system security in their design and implementation.

Marili Männik,
Executive Director ad interim

MISSION

We aim to support the EU and the Member States in their efforts to keep Europe open and secure through advanced technology

VISION

We strive to provide innovative and practical solutions for the EU's evolving needs while driving digital transformation in the area of justice and home affairs

CORE VALUES

ACCOUNTABILITY: deploying a robust governance framework, cost-efficient operations and sound financial management

TRANSPARENCY: engaging in continuous dialogue with key stakeholders to define eu-LISA's long-term development strategy

EXCELLENCE: having the right organisational structure, processes, and people to ensure service continuity and quality of tools provided to the Member States

CONTINUITY: making the best use of expertise, knowledge and investments provided by the Member States, and their continued development

TEAMWORK: empowering each team member to make the best use of their knowledge and experience, contributing to shared success

CUSTOMER FOCUS: ensuring that eu-LISA's activities are always aligned with the needs and demands of its stakeholders



MANAGEMENT SITE*
TALLINN,
ESTONIA

OPERATIONAL SITE
STRASBOURG,
FRANCE

BACKUP SITE
ST. JOHANN IM PONGAU,
AUSTRIA

LIAISON OFFICE
BRUSSELS,
BELGIUM

*including the operational management of e-CODEX

ACTIVITIES

SUPPORTING THE IMPLEMENTATION OF JHA* POLICIES

- EU INTERNAL SECURITY
- VISA
- MIGRATION & ASYLUM
- JUSTICE

MANAGEMENT OF JHA SYSTEMS

- SIS
- VIS
- EURODAC
- e-CODEX

DEVELOPMENT OF NEW SYSTEMS

- EES
- ETIAS
- ECRIS-TCN
- Interoperability

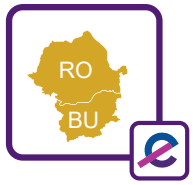
- 24/7 OPERATIONAL SUPPORT
- USER TRAINING
- INNOVATION & TECHNOLOGY MONITORING
- EXPERTISE TO STAKEHOLDERS

*Justice and Home Affairs

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



Frontex connection to SIS



Bulgaria and Romania full access to VIS



e-CODEX operational management takeover



Launch New EURODAC development



Entry/Exit System baseline functionalities with sBMS and VIS for EES



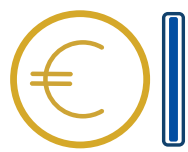
shared Biometric Matching Service (sBMS) readiness for biometric operations

JHA2AAN Presidency

JHA Agency Network 2024 presidency



97% of overall **audit recommendations** implemented



100% budget execution rate for commitments and payments

SIS

SCHENGEN INFORMATION SYSTEM

AVAILABILITY



99.78%
TARGET ≥99.99%

PARTIALLY ON TARGET

RESPONSE TIME



100%
TARGET ≥99.50%

ON TARGET

Set up in 1995 as a compensatory measure for the lifting of internal borders to facilitate free movement, SIS has become the **most widely used information-sharing system** for European law enforcement and border control authorities for exchanging alerts on wanted or missing persons and lost or stolen objects.

SIS is a key component of the Schengen architecture, enabling smart and efficient management of the EU's external borders and contributing to internal security.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

CONNECTION OF FRONTEX

June: the Agency **integrated Frontex with SIS**, the last stakeholder to connect as per the current plan.

CONNECTION WITH ETIAS

Completed design and functional testing of the **inter-connection module to ETIAS for its entry into operation** in 2026.

SIS IN NUMBERS - 2024

DATA STORED

93.2M +3% 2022

ALERTS IN THE DATABASE

ON PERSONS
1.8%

ON OBJECTS
98.2%

OPERATIONS

15.0B +2% 2023

SEARCHES

ALPAHNUMERIC SEARCHES
99.5%

BIOMETRIC SEARCHES
0.5%

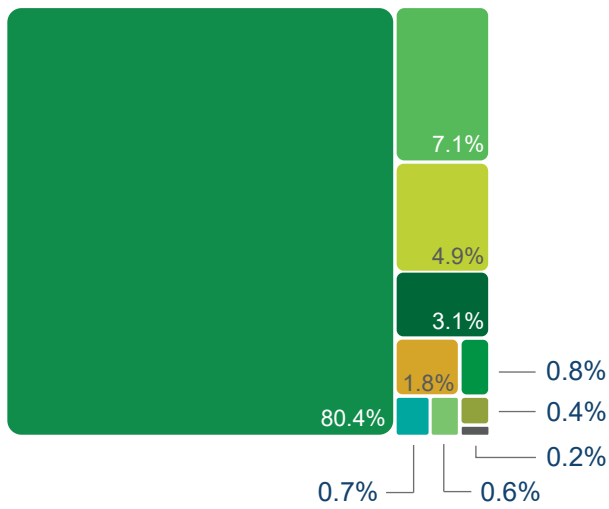
397,804 +11% 2023

HITS ON FOREIGN ALERTS

DAILY AVERAGE
1,087

SIS ALERTS BY TYPE

- Issued documents
- Vehicle registration documents
- License plates
- Vehicles
- Persons
- Blank documents
- Firearms
- Information tech items
- Industry equipment
- Others



VIS

VISA INFORMATION SYSTEM

AVAILABILITY

99.92%

TARGET ≥99.99%

PARTIALLY ON TARGET

RESPONSE TIME

99.89%

TARGET ≥100%

PARTIALLY ON TARGET

Operational since 2011, VIS is used for processing **visa applications** and the management of **short-stay visas** for people travelling to or transiting through the Schengen area.

With its biometric search functionality, enabling identification at the borders, VIS helps combat visa fraud by identifying persons not fulfilling the conditions for entry or staying in the Schengen area, as well as preventing visa shopping between different Member States.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS



INTEGRATION OF BULGARIA AND ROMANIA

April: enabled **full access to VIS for Bulgaria and Romania**, lifting checks on persons at internal air and sea borders, marking their partial accession to the Schengen Area.

CONNECTION WITH EES

All required functionalities successfully delivered to enable a connection with the Entry/Exit System (EES) from VIS side.

VIS IN NUMBERS - 2024

DATA STORED

46M

-10% 2023

VISA APPLICATIONS

FINGERPRINTS
42M

FACIAL IMAGES
46M

OPERATIONS

259M

+23% 2023

OVERALL OPERATIONS

VISA APPLICATIONS CREATED
12M

ALPHANUMERIC SEARCHES
32M

BIOMETRIC SEARCHES
7.6M

BIOMETRIC AUTHENTICATIONS
7M

BIOMETRIC DATA MIGRATION

Migration of VIS real biometric data (46 million files) to the shared Biometric Matching Service (sBMS) conducted **in support of the sBMS accuracy measurements** for its future integration with EES.

WORK IN PROGRESS: REVISED VIS

Since 2021, VIS has been undergoing a major upgrade that will expand its scope to include l**ong-stay visas and residence permits**, and establish connections with EES and ETIAS to enable the automated cross-checking of data on incoming travellers.
The revised VIS is scheduled to entry into operation in 2027/2028.

EURODAC

EUROPEAN DACTYLOSCOPY DATABASE

AVAILABILITY

99.91%

TARGET ≥99.99%

PARTIALLY ON TARGET

RESPONSE TIME

99.99%

TARGET ≥99.45%

ON TARGET

Operational since 2003, **Eurodac** is the EU database of **digitalised fingerprints** for the management of asylum applications under the Dublin Regulation.

The adoption of the **new Eurodac regulation (and Screening Regulations**) in May 2024, under the EU's Pact on Migration and Asylum, will significantly expand the system's scope, transforming the existing fingerprint database into a **fully-fledged asylum and migration database**.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

NEW EURODAC DEVELOPMENT

June: started developing **New Eurodac**, using an **iterative and agile process**, as well as cloud capabilities and delivering first set of business and technical documentation in December.

MINIMAL UPGRADE PROJECT

Ongoing: upgrading the biometric matcher, database management system, synchronisation mechanism, and replacing hardware components, for the existing systems.

EURODAC IN NUMBERS - 2024

DATA STORED

7.7M

+4% 2023

DATA SETS STORED
(FINGERPRINT SETS)

ASYLUM SEEKERS
7.3M

IRREGULAR BORDER CROSSINGS
0.4M

OPERATIONS

1.4M

-17% 2023

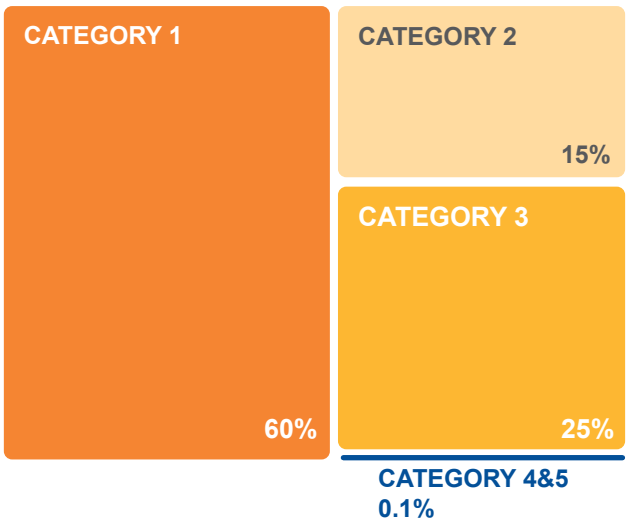
DATA SETS TRANSMITTED

FINGERPRINT DATA SETS: STORED vs TRANSMITTED

Data is **stored** only for asylum applications (10 years) and irregular crossings (18 months).

Transmitted data sets fall under 5 categories (see below).

FINGERPRINT DATA SETS TRANSMITTED



CATEGORY 1
asylum applications

CATEGORY 2
irregular border-crossings

CATEGORY 3
illegal presence in Schengen Area

CATEGORY 4&5
law enforcement searches

NEW SYSTEMS IN DEVELOPMENT

The effective management of Europe's external borders and internal security relies upon efficient data sharing and information exchange. Since its establishment in 2012, eu-LISA has managed three IT systems that constitute the cornerstones of the **Schengen architecture: SIS**, **VIS**, and **Eurodac**.

In 2018, the Agency was tasked with the development of several new IT systems, together with the **interoperability architecture** for the EU's justice and home affairs (JHA) domain. Once operational, this overarching systems interoperability will enable **more efficient data sharing and information exchange**, providing law enforcement authorities single-point access to comprehensive information.

In the coming years, eu-LISA is scheduled to launch **three new systems: EES**, **ETIAS**, **ECRIS-TCN**. These systems will further improve the management of Schengen external borders and reinforce internal security while also delivering a more **seamless experience for international travellers** headed for the EU.

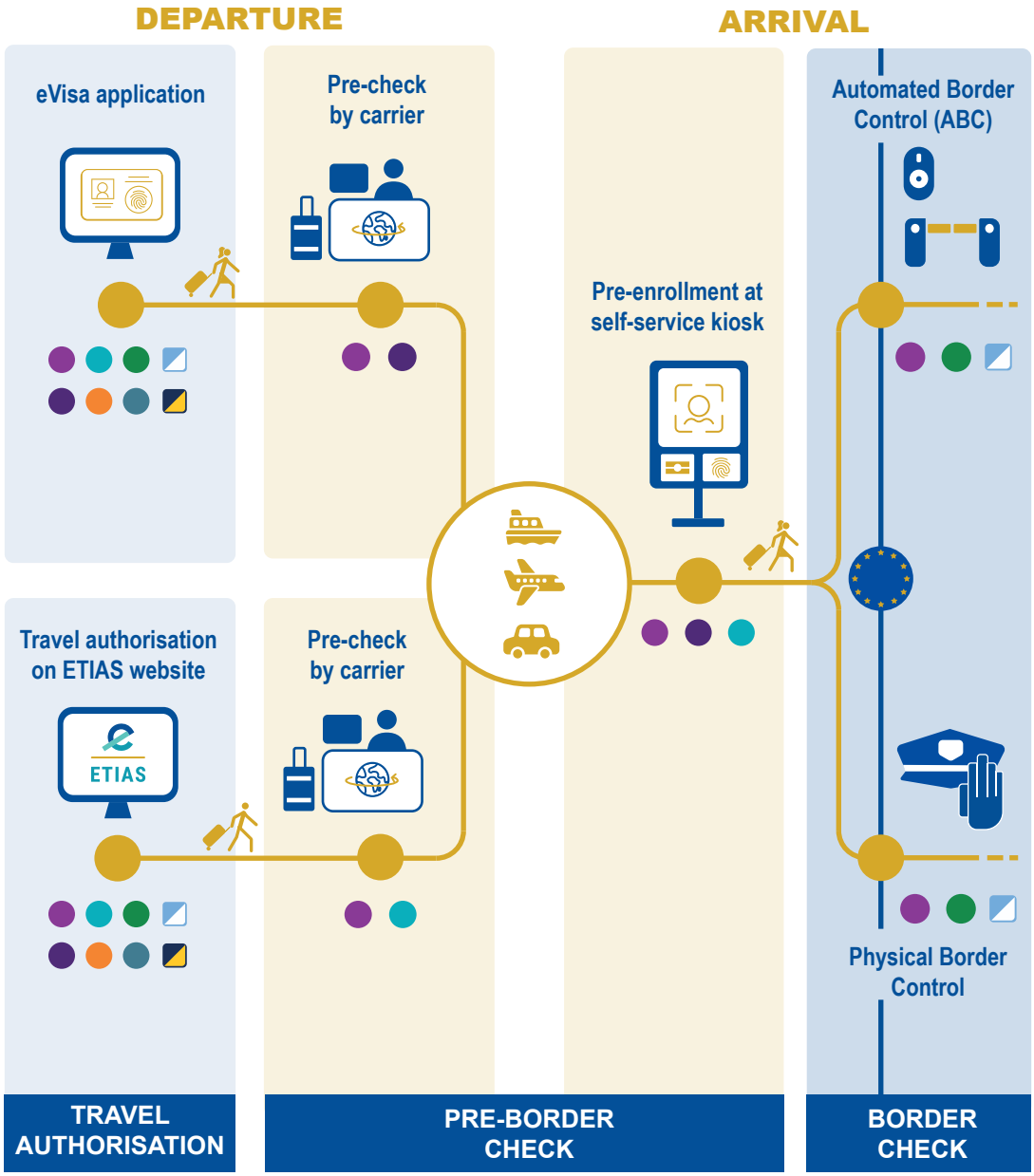
Additionally, in 2024 eu-LISA completed the take over of the operational management of **e-CODEX**, a digital platform that facilitates cross-border judicial proceedings, and further increasing the Agency contribution to **EU's justice domain.**

eu-LISA is developing **new digital solutions** to strengthen Schengen's IT infrastructure. These include the **Joint Investigation Teams collaboration** platform to support cross-border investigations, the **Prüm II central router** for secure cross-border law enforcement communication, and early work on the **Advance Passenger Information router** to facilitate traveller's identification during border-crossings.

The **traveller continuum infographic** (next page) outlines the traveller journey from the perspective of third-country nationals planning a short-stay visit to the Schengen area. The figure presents the **integrated management of the EU's external borders,** once the IO roadmap is implemented and the different checks operated automatically by systems and on databases at each step.



THE TRAVELLER CONTINUUM: FUTURE STEPS



Systems and databases checked at different steps

EES · ETIAS · SIS · Interpol databases

VIS · Eurodac · ECRIS-TCN · Europol database

EES ENTRY/ EXIT SYSTEM

EES is one of two new IT systems that is set to **modernise the EU's border control** processes by replacing the current practice of manual stamping of passports with the electronic registration of all third-country nationals entering and exiting the Schengen area. The system will include an online **interface for passenger carriers**, enabling them to verify the right of entry to the Schengen area prior to boarding.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS



FULL BASELINE VERSION

Delivered **all baseline functionalities** with sBMS and VIS for EES to Member States and Europol



ENTRY INTO OPERATION REHEARSAL

October 2024: eu-LISA conducted a **joint rehearsal exercise** (together with **sBMS** and **VIS for EES**), simulating the full sequence of activities of entry into operation.

NEXT STEPS



EUROPEAN TRAVEL INFORMATION AND AUTHORISATION SYSTEM

ETIAS

Complementing EES, ETIAS is an **online pre-screening system** for visa-exempt third-country nationals, which will **introduce travel authorisation as a new condition** for entry to the Schengen area. The system will be launched together with a dedicated **web interface and mobile application for travellers**.

ETIAS travel authorisations will be checked by air, sea and land carriers prior to boarding and later also by border guards. In addition to **facilitating border-crossing**, ETIAS will contribute to the EU's internal security by enabling the **identification of potential security, migration and public health risks.**

KEY HIGHLIGHTS



MAKING HEADWAY

Delivered the **updated software specifications and user interface mock-ups** to further support Member State preparations.

INTEROPERABILITY



INTEGRATION WITH INTEROPERABILITY

Provided end-users access to the ETIAS software and ESP queries, supported by a simulator to create synthetic data (similar to real-world conditions).

INTEROPERABILITY

Interoperability is the capability of interconnected systems to share data and exchange information. eu-LISA has been tasked with developing the new **interoperability architecture for the EU's JHA domain** to improve the efficient management of Europe's external borders, internal security and migration.

This overarching systems interoperability will be enabled by dedicated components that will make it easier for European law enforcement authorities to **search and exchange information across all JHA databases and systems** managed by the Agency.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS



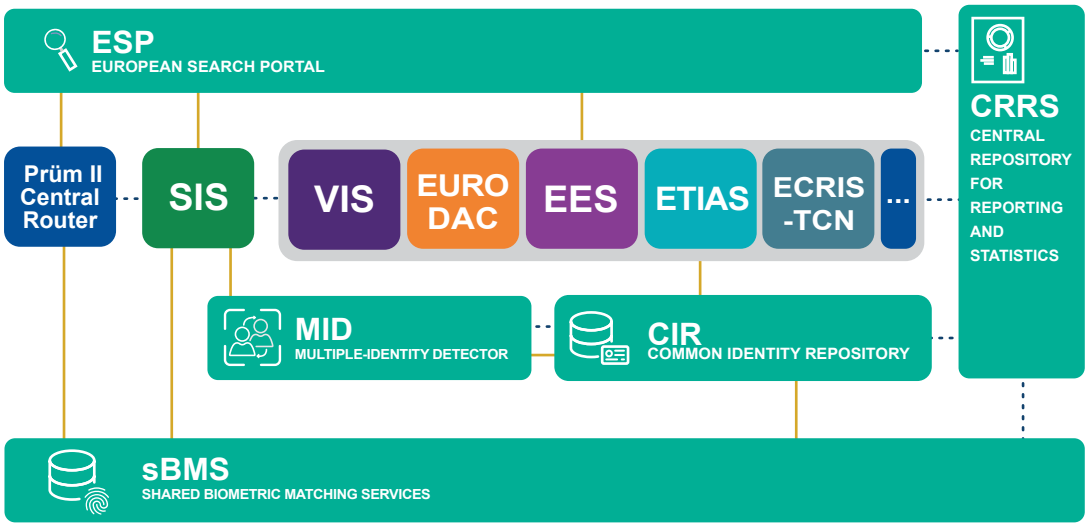
sBMS OPERATIVE READINESS

Accuracy measurements conducted in 2024 showed that the **biometric accuracy of sBMS exceeds expectations** and its matching threshold is fit-for-purpose.

ROLLOUT OF INTEROPERABILITY COMPONENTS



INTEROPERABILITY DIAGRAM



INTEROPERABILITY COMPONENTS

European Search Portal (ESP) will enable users to conduct single searches across all JHA information systems they are authorised to access;

Common Identity Repository (CIR) will be a database of biographical information on third-country nationals to ensure reliable identification;

multiple-identity detector (MID) will enable the detection of multiple identities linked to the same biometric data across all JHA systems;

shared biometric matching service (sBMS) for cross-matching of identity data with biometric identifiers across all JHA systems;

central repository for reporting and statistics (CRRS) will provide cross-system statistical data and analytical reporting for policy, operational and data quality purposes.

DIGITALISATION OF JUSTICE

e-CODEX

e-Justice Communication via Online Data Exchange

The e-CODEX system provides the digital infrastructure for the secure transmission of electronic content in **cross-border judicial proceedings.** The system serves as the key technological enabler for the digitalisation of the EU's justice domain, ensuring a more efficient process for citizens and businesses across Europe.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS



TAKEOVER

June 2024: eu-LISA formally took over the **operational management of the e-CODEX** system, marking its first-time management of an internet-facing and cloud-hosted solution.

JITs CP | JOINT INVESTIGATION TEAMS COLLABORATION PLATFORM

The JITs CP will **facilitate communication** and cooperation between European judicial and law enforcement authorities, relevant EU agencies, and the European Anti-Fraud Office (OLAF), improving the efficiency and effectiveness of **cross-border investigations and prosecutions** (to be delivered in 2025).

ECRIS-TCN

European Criminal Records Information System on third-country nationals and stateless persons

Under EU law, national courts must consider previous convictions when passing sentences in criminal cases. ECRIS was set up to facilitate **information exchange on the criminal records** of European citizens. ECRIS-TCN will supplement the existing system with information on criminal records of third-country nationals and stateless persons convicted in the EU.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

READY FOR TESTING

Delivered to end-users the **final release of interface software and central system simulator**, covering most of the scope and major functionalities.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

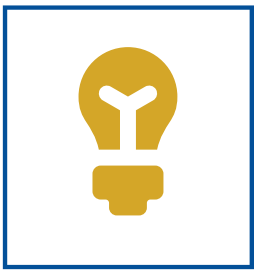
May 2024: formally **started development**, followed by the **delivery of several mock-ups** as a preliminary visualisation of the platform's central features and interface.

RESEARCH AND INNOVATION

As a **driver of digital transformation** in the JHA domain, eu-LISA monitors research and technological innovation to provide **state-of-the-art expertise** to its stakeholders. In addition, the Agency maps and tests novel solutions to address specific operational challenges and capability gaps.

Its functions include supporting the implementation of the **EU Framework Programme for Research and Innovation**, and active participation in the **EU Innovation Hub for Internal Security**.

INNOVATION



- **Strategy for the Research and Innovation function**
  Framework to guide sustainable innovation within the Agency
- **Artificial Intelligence:**
  Mapping and preparing for the implementation of use cases for genAI solutions to enhance eu-LISA's organisational performance
- **EU Innovation Hub for Internal Security**:
  Chairing the Hub's Biometrics Cluster

PUBLICATIONS 2024



- Tech brief of biometrics: Part 1
  A Paradigm Shift in Identity Management and Security Technologies
- Tech brief of biometrics: Part 2
  What Added Value Does eu-LISA Bring Through Biometrics?

INDUSTRY ROUNDTABLES



A regular event, bringing together Member States, EU institutions, and the industry to look at how the industry can address the technological needs of the Member States.

- June 2024 in Antwerp, Belgium
  Going to the Cloud: Why it matters for the EU public sector and how to make it work

- November 2024 in Budapest, Hungary
  EU Justice and Home Affairs in the Age of AI: fostering innovations and managing risks

TRAINING TO MEMBER STATES AND JHA AGENCIES

eu-LISA provided **fit-for-purpose training on the technical use of JHA systems** to IT experts and other law enforcement officials from the Member States and JHA agencies that manage the IT systems. The training offer is tailored to emerging needs and identified knowledge gaps. **Over 90% of the training activities are delivered online**, holding a few face-to-face courses per year.

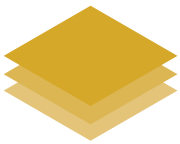
Additionally, eu-LISA organised an e-learning workshop to **exchange best practices with other EU agencies**, within the scope of its presidency of the JHA Agencies Network.



INFRASTRUCTURE AND NETWORK

All information systems managed by eu-LISA are hosted in **data centres**, whereas the connectivity between the systems and their end-users is enabled by the **communication infrastructure** running on the core network.

INFRASTRUCTURE AND PLATFORMS



SMART HOSTING INITIATIVE

Common shared platform: scalable and standardised infrastructure platform for providing the underlying technical services needed to run all IT systems managed by eu-LISA



Comprehensive cloud platform: scalable, agile and secure cloud platform, based on Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) and Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS), offering **faster setup and easier scaling of application environments**



DATA CENTRE CAPACITY INCREASE

Start of the installation of a **second modular datacentre** in Strasbourg to provide additional capacity for new systems

NETWORKS AND COMMUNICATIONS

Communication infrastructure for secure and reliable data transfer between the JHA systems and end-users

AVAILABILITY



99.99%
wide-area network (WAN) for SIS and VIS

COMMUNICATIONS ENCRYPTION



eu-LISA manages an additional layer of encryption to the one of the service provider

DIRECT SUPPORT TO OPERATIONS

SUPPORT TO OPERATIONS

eu-LISA Service Desk provides **24/7 support to end-users** to ensure uninterrupted provision of high-quality services.



1783
Service requests

3517
Incidents

95%
Performance indicator

97.8%
Customer satisfaction

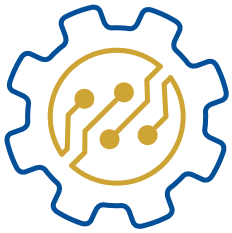
SECURITY AND BUSINESS CONTINUITY



Ensuring the **security** of the EU's JHA information systems and the **safety of the sensitive data** hosted are among the Agency's highest priorities:

- **Security Business Continuity Exercises 2024** completed for SIS, VIS, EURODAC
- **Compliance with Cybersecurity Regulation** ensured through a security maturity assessment

TECHNOLOGY AND SOFTWARE ENGINEERING



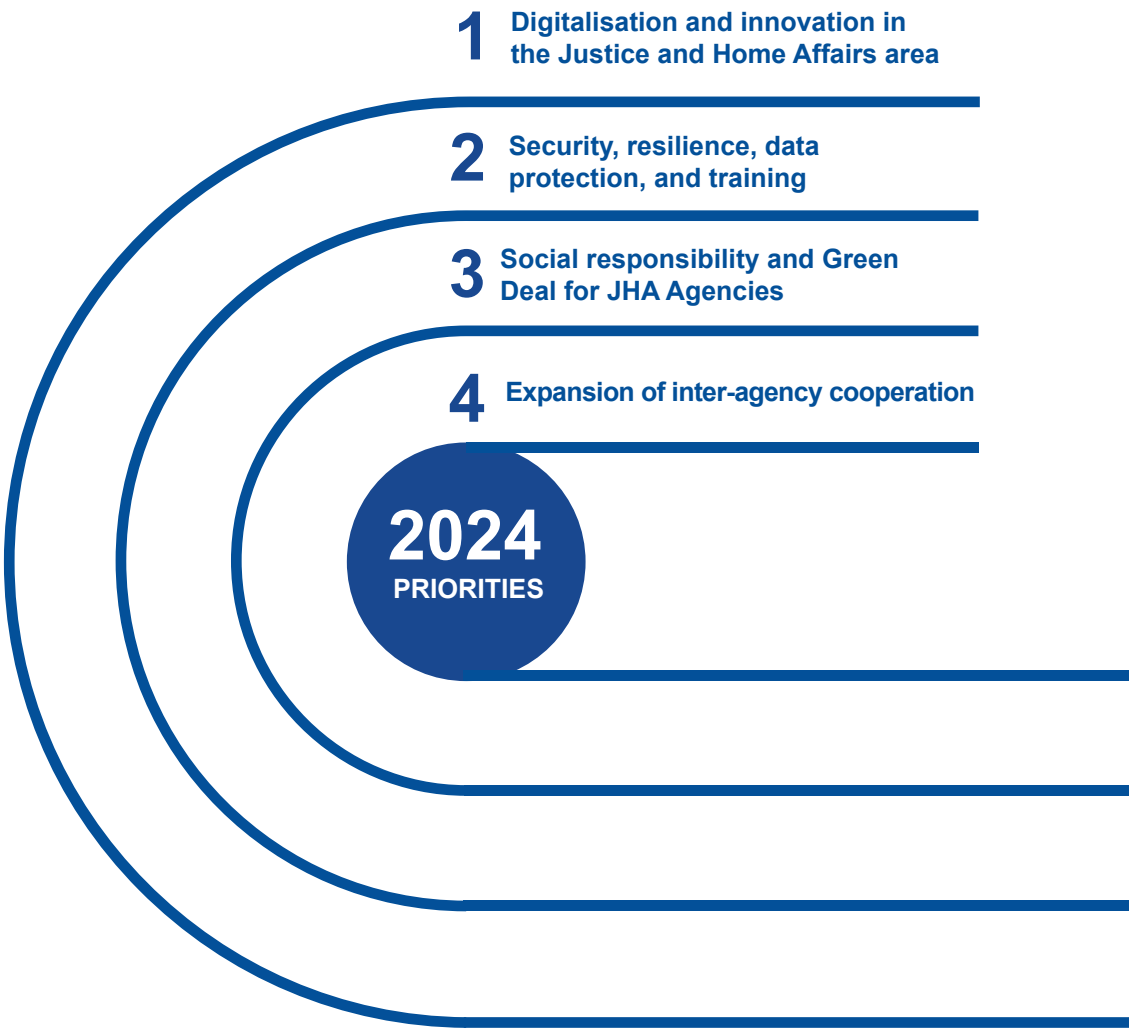
SOFTWARE FACTORY

Launched initiative aimed at providing a **standardised framework for agile and iterative software development.**

JHAAN PRESIDENCY

EIGE EUAA CEPOL EUDA eu-LISA Eurojust Europol FRA Frontex

2022 - 2024 JHAAN TRIO PRESIDENCY



1 **Joint security and business continuity exercise** for IT systems and workshops focusing on cybersecurity incident response and management



2 Training team organised a **workshop on e-learning** to share best practices and exchange knowledge on **latest trends and innovative approaches in training**



3 **Social Responsibility:** awareness sessions on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Green Deal: awareness session on energy efficiency and workshop on eco-friendly practices



4 **JHAAN Staff Exchange Programme:** facilitated 50 bilateral exchanges between 6 agencies.



JHAAN Presidency

GOVERNANCE AND COMPLIANCE

The governance function ensures that eu-LISA operates in compliance with the EU regulatory framework by applying sound and transparent administrative practices.

GOVERNANCE



STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT ACTION PLAN

eu-LISA launched an ambitious action plan to evolve its ways of working, to be more in control of key area of its development, using Agile methods and the latest technologies (cloud and AI).



AUDIT RECOMMENDATIONS

Closing outstanding audit recommendations: significant progress made, with 97% implementation rate.



ENVIRONMENTAL MANAGEMENT

Published its **first-ever sustainability report** and a factsheet on carbon footprint results. External audit for EMAS certification confirmed the **good level of its environmental management system**.

DATA PROTECTION



- Working closely with the **European Data Protection Supervisor** (EDPS) to ensure high-level data protection
- Drafting data protection impact assessments (**DPIAs**)

FINANCIAL AND HUMAN RESOURCES

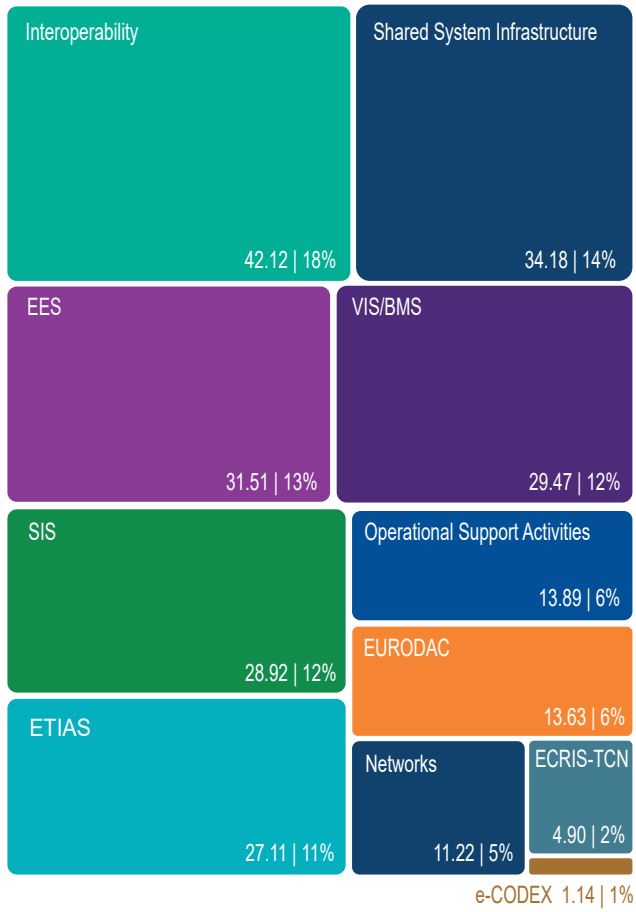
TOTAL EXPENDITURE
307.39 M

STAFF EXPENDITURE
45.66 M

INFRASTRUCTURE and OPERATING EXPENDITURE
23.64 M

OPERATIONAL EXPENDITURE
238.09 M

OPERATIONAL EXPENDITURE BREAKDOWN
(in million EUR)



STAFF BY LOCATION

375
STAFF



25% TALLINN HQ

73% STRASBOURG TECHNICAL SITE

2% BRUSSELS LIAISON OFFICE

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First Edition.

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